

August: The PC AT

The IBM PC AT was IBM's second-generation series of computers that ran on the 6 MHz 286 processor (mentioned earlier). The PC AT (Advanced Technology) improved upon the protected mode, which we've mentioned earlier, which led to better multitasking capabilities. Under the hood, the PC AT boasted of a 30 MB hard disk, 515 KB of RAM, a 5.25-inch floppy drive, and a full-stroke keyboard with mouse. It ran PC-DOS 3.0 or OS/2 1.x.



The IBM PC AT: a worthy successor, but unimpressive nevertheless!

Despite all this “latest” technology, there quite a few problems: the hard disk and floppy drives were unreliable, and the serial port chip used on the motherboard had a problematic input/output flow. The IBM PC AT was never therefore able to capture dominant market share at the time.

IBM was very protective about its mainframe business. A computer that ran on the 286 and had a faster clock rate was considered detrimental to that business. IBM therefore limited the PC AT to 8 MHz.

August: The Floppy As We Know It

When Sony first introduced this format in 1984, it was not used a lot apart from on its MSX line of computers or on the HP-150 computer. Things started to improve when manufacturers like Apple, Atari, Amiga, Commodore, and ST Line started to choose the format.



The standard 3.5-inch floppy

The construction of the 3.5 inch floppy was better than that of the 5.25-inch ones: it was encased in a rugged plastic body, as you know,